

YPRES 1914–1918: FLANDERS FIELDS & LOCAL HERITAGE

3-Day Immersive Study Tour · Thursday 1st – Saturday 3rd October 2026

Base: Peace Village Hostel
Mesen (Messines), Belgium

3-DAY FIELD EXPEDITION ITINERARY

DAY 1 THU 1 OCT

Departure, North Salient & Mine Warfare

- **06:15 Meet at Meoncross:** 06:30 coach departure; Eurotunnel Le Shuttle crossing to Calais.
- **14:30 Essex Farm ADS:** John McCrae dugout ('In Flanders Fields') & 15-year-old Pte Strudwick.
- **15:15 Langemarck Cemetery:** The somber *Studentenfriedhof* & German commemoration.
- **16:00 Hooge Crater Museum:** Preserved frontline trenches, deep mine craters & archaeology.
- **17:45 Peace Village Hostel:** Check-in at Mesen, 2-course dinner & evening study debrief.

DAY 2 FRI 2 OCT

Passchendaele Ridge, Medical Care & The Menin Gate

- **09:15 Vancouver Corner:** Brooding Soldier memorial & 1915 gas attacks analysis.
- **09:45 Sanctuary Wood (Hill 62):** Authentic preserved British frontline trenches & tunnels.
- **11:30 Supermarket Lunch Stop:** Supervised stop in Ypres (pupils select lunch with Euros).
- **13:00 Tyne Cot Cemetery:** World's largest CWGC cemetery; locating our local fallen.
- **14:15 Lijssenthoek Cemetery:** Casualty Clearing Station medical care & Nurse Nellie Spindler.
- **15:45 Passchendaele Museum:** 20ft underground dugout system & recreated trenches.
- **20:00 Menin Gate Ceremony:** Solemn Last Post Ceremony, wreath-laying & Panel 35 tribute.

DAY 3 SAT 3 OCT

Daylight Menin Gate, Civilian Rebirth & Poperinge

- **09:15 Daylight Menin Gate:** Architectural study & morning walk atop Ypres Ramparts.
- **10:30 Grote Markt & Chocolatier:** Supervised visit to De Groote chocolatier for gift shopping.
- **11:20 Talbot House (Poperinge):** Historic 'Every Man's Club' soldiers' sanctuary & chapel.
- **12:45 Town Centre Lunch & Death Cells:** Supervised lunch; visiting preserved execution cells.
- **14:30 Return Journey:** Depart for Calais; 17:50 Le Shuttle (17:30 UK arrival); ~20:00 at school.



Explore the Expedition on Our Digital Field Companion

Explore the full itinerary, interactive maps, cemetery coordinates, local hero dossiers, and the complete 16-poem anthology from any smartphone or tablet.

 meoncross-history.netlify.app (Select 'History Battlefield Tour')

FOOTWEAR, CLOTHING & TOWELS

- **TOWELS (Mandatory):** Pupils **MUST bring their own bath/shower towel**. The hostel does not provide towels for school groups.
- **Sanctuary Wood Muddy Trenches:** Deep, authentic frontline trenches are wet and muddy. Pupils **MUST bring a separate pair of wellington boots or sturdy walking boots**, plus a clean, separate pair of shoes/trainers for coach and hostel.
- **Sturdy Plastic Bag:** Every pupil must pack a strong plastic bag (or bin liner) in their daypack to seal away muddy boots before boarding the coach!
- **Waterproof Coat:** Hooded rain jacket. We are outdoors regardless of light rain.
- **Warm Layers, Hat & Gloves:** Autumn in Belgium is cold on exposed ridges. Standing still at the 8:00 PM Menin Gate ceremony gets very cold.

FOOD, DIETARY, EUROS & DEVICES

- **Strict No Nuts / No Sesame Policy:** Zero-tolerance across tour. Strictly **NO nuts** (peanuts, tree nuts, Nutella, cereal bars) or **sesame** (seeds, buns, hummus, tahini).
- **Day 1 Travel Food:** Packed breakfast, lunch & snacks from home in daypack (strictly nut- and sesame-free; no motorway fast food). Refillable water bottle.
- **Spending Money (€30–€40 Euros):** Cash for supervised Friday & Saturday bakery/supermarket lunches in Ypres & Poperinge and chocolates, plus €5–€10 for hostel soft drinks.
- **Luggage:** 1 main holdall (<15kg) for coach hold + 1 small daypack inside coach. Casual clothes for hostel. Roll-on deodorant only (**NO aerosols**).
- **Plug Adapter & Phone Curfew:** European 2-pin adapter. Phones allowed by day; **collected each night in staff lockbag at curfew** for proper rest.

ACCOMMODATION & ROOMING ALLOCATIONS

Expedition Base: Peace Village Hostel, Mesen, Belgium (+32 57 226 040 · peacevillage.be). Secure rural educational centre with keycard access, ensuite studios (4–7 bunks), and staff on same corridors with active evening checks. **Rooming Allocations:** Rooming allocations are currently being completed in school. If your child has any questions or concerns, please reassure them that they can come and speak to Mr Lovett directly.

MEDICAL & PRESCRIPTION PROTOCOL

Departure Handover: Prescriptions & travel sickness meds handed to staff at registration on Thursday 1st Oct (06:15).
Strict Packaging Rule: All meds **MUST be in original pharmacy packaging**, clearly displaying **child's name, dosage & instructions**.

TRIP WHATSAPP BROADCAST GROUP

Travel Updates & ETAs: A dedicated broadcast group will be set up prior to the trip for live journey updates, visit photos, and Channel crossing ETAs.
Photo Permissions: Staff will verify individually with parents regarding any photo restrictions prior to departure.

PARENT ACTION ITEMS & NEXT STEPS

ITEM / ACTION	DETAILS & REQUIREMENTS	DEADLINE
Passport & GHIC Collection	Hand valid UK passport (≥3m validity) & GHIC card into the school office.	Due Fri 18 Sep
Code of Conduct Form	Signed agreement by pupil & parent (noting Nut & Sesame Policy) to school office.	Due Fri 18 Sep
Rooming Allocations	Allocations currently being finalised; pupils can see Mr Lovett with any queries.	In Progress
Medications & Pharmacy Labels	Hand to staff at 06:15 registration in original packaging with child's name & dosage.	Thu 1 Oct (06:15)
Euros Spending Money (€)	Provide €30–€40 cash for Fri & Sat supermarket lunches + €5–€10 hostel soft drinks.	For Departure Day
Trip WhatsApp Broadcast Group	Broadcast group will be set up prior to departure for live travel updates & ETAs.	Prior to Departure

 **TRIP MOBILE (ON-TOUR 24/7): 07825 297749** (+44 7825 297749) School Base Emergency: **+44 (0)1329 662182**
24/7 Contact Protocol: Carried by tour leaders at all times. Call in an emergency, and this is the number staff will call you from. **Parents/emergency contacts must ensure someone is contactable 24/7 on designated phone numbers throughout the tour.**